

PARENT TIPS

Getting involved

Many parents feel anxious at the idea of their teens dating, but it is perfectly normal for teens to want to date as they grow up. It's difficult to gauge how much involvement is needed from parents—it really depends on the teen, as well as their age and maturity level.

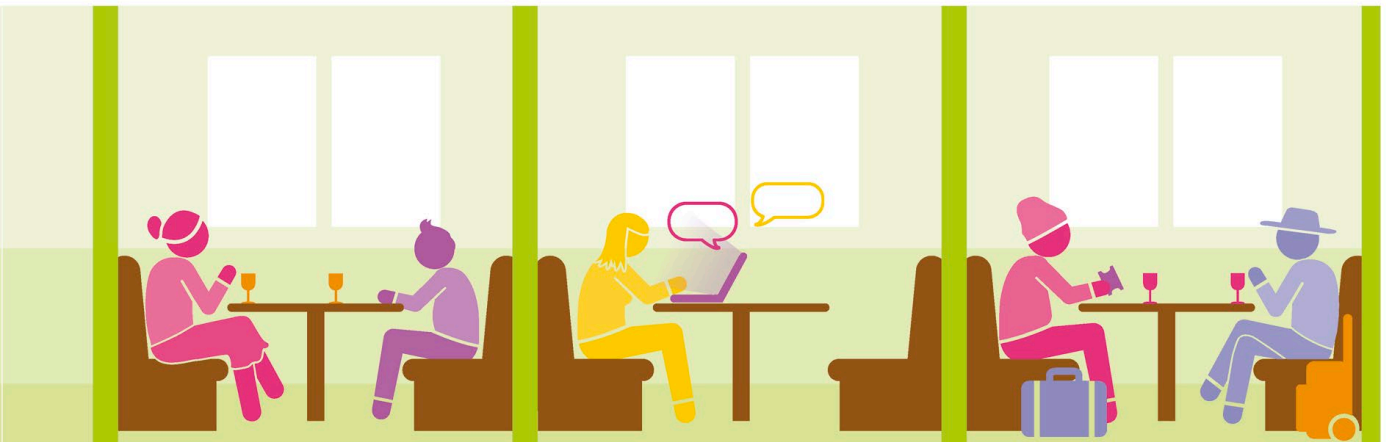
- Teens have no lessons on dating. Speak to your teen about personal values and respecting each other, and how they apply to dating.
- Provide guidance before your teen starts dating, and continue to be available to offer help and advice on the relationship.
- Set some dating rules early on, such as where your teen can and can't go, and then trust your teen to be able to figure out how they want to proceed with these rules in place.
- Respect your teen's privacy.

Healthy dating

Dating is a process of getting to know another person better and, if both people want to, being in a long-term relationship. While it can be tempting for a person to spend every single second with the one that they're dating, it is important to strike a balance to ensure that each individual has their own time, as well as quality time with their boyfriend or girlfriend. This helps to build the foundations for a healthy relationship.

**◀ Caring couple**

People who are dating often support each other through hard times. How the individuals in the relationship respond to these difficulties will often determine how healthy the relationship is.

**Age gaps**

Older people have more life experience than younger people, including being sexually intimate with others. When two people of different ages date, these facts can give the older person more power in the relationship and can lead to mismatched expectations.

Online dating

Dating apps are a way of meeting new and like-minded people. Some are tailored for specific identities, such as religion and sexuality. If someone wants to meet an online "date" in person, it's important to meet in a public place, and only share personal details once they know the other person well.

Long distance

Whether by choice or design, some couples find themselves living in different parts of the world. To maintain a long-distance relationship, it is important to get the level of communication right—too much can become a chore, while too little can be seen as a lack of interest.